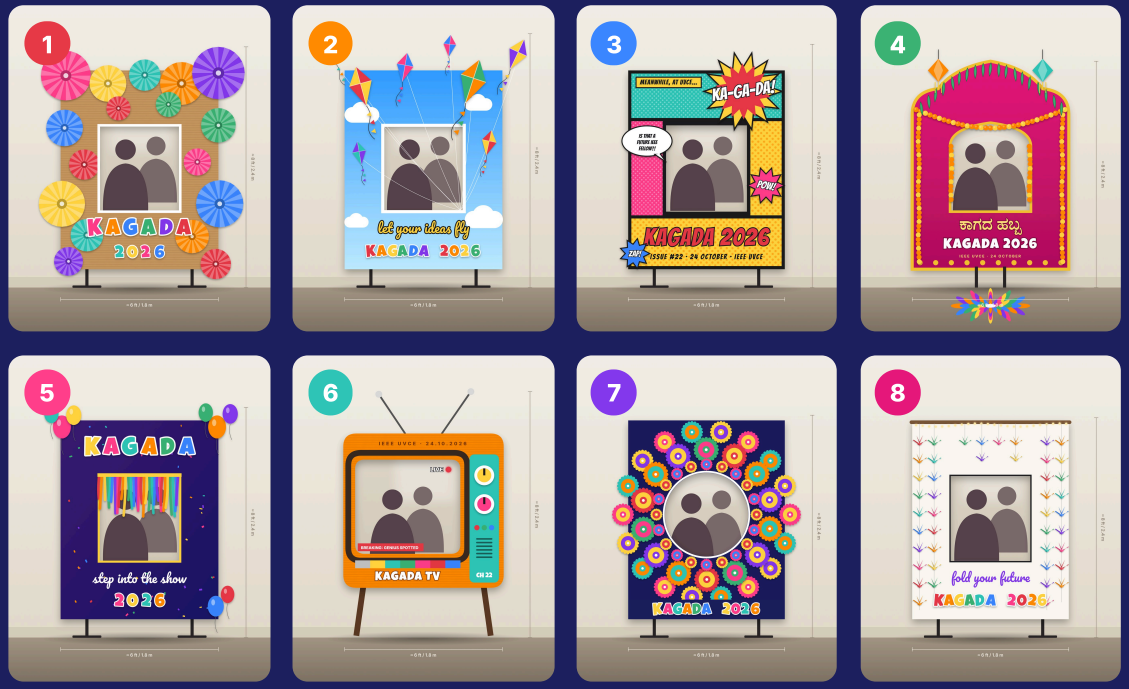
KAGADA 2026 · DIY PHOTO BOOTHS

MAKE IT LOUD.

8 colourful photo booths you can build in **3 days** from cardboard, chart paper, crepe paper, paper plates, kites, marigolds and fairy lights. Most of them cost **under ₹500**.

Each one fits the Geoshakthi stand and board (≈ 6 × 8 ft). Reuse it and just change the front.





01
PAPER FAN BURST

Forty chart papers, folded into a firework.

💰 ₹600–900 ⏱️ 1 day, 6 people

THE IDEA

The plain Geoshakthi board disappears under an explosion of accordion-folded paper fans (rosettes) in every colour, with big hand-cut cardboard letters on top. It looks like the window is bursting with confetti.

YOU'LL NEED

- Geoshakthi stand + board (or 2 big flattened boxes)
- 40 to 50 coloured chart papers
- Glue gun, double-sided tape, stapler
- 1 extra cardboard box for the letters

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Fold each chart paper in 2 cm accordion pleats, fold in half, and glue the edges to make a circle. Staple the centre.
2. Glue the biggest fans at the corners first, then fill the gaps with smaller ones. Let 4 or 5 stick out past the edges.
3. Cut KAGADA 2026 letters from cardboard, paint each one a different colour, and glue them on.



02
GAALIPATA KITE SKY

Let your ideas fly.

💰 ₹400–700 ⏱️ 1 day, 4 people

THE IDEA

A bright blue sky full of colourful kites (gaalipata, Karnataka's favourite) with paper tails, flying off the top of the board. Every kite string runs down to a giant spool held by the person in the photo.

YOU'LL NEED

- Board painted sky blue (2 litres of distemper, or blue chart paper)
- 8 to 10 paper kites: ₹10–20 each at a kite shop, or homemade from tissue paper and sticks
- White chart paper for clouds
- Thread, ribbon offcuts for kite tails
- A cardboard tube for a spool prop

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Paint the board sky blue, lighter at the bottom. Glue on white chart-paper clouds.
2. Pin the kites around the window at different angles. Let 3 fly above the top edge, held on thin sticks taped behind.
3. Run all the strings down to one spot near the window so a participant can hold the spool.



≈ 8 ft / 2.4 m

≈ 6 ft / 1.8 m

03
Comic Book POW!

You're the hero of this issue.

💰 ₹300–500 ⏱️ 1 day, 4 people

THE IDEA

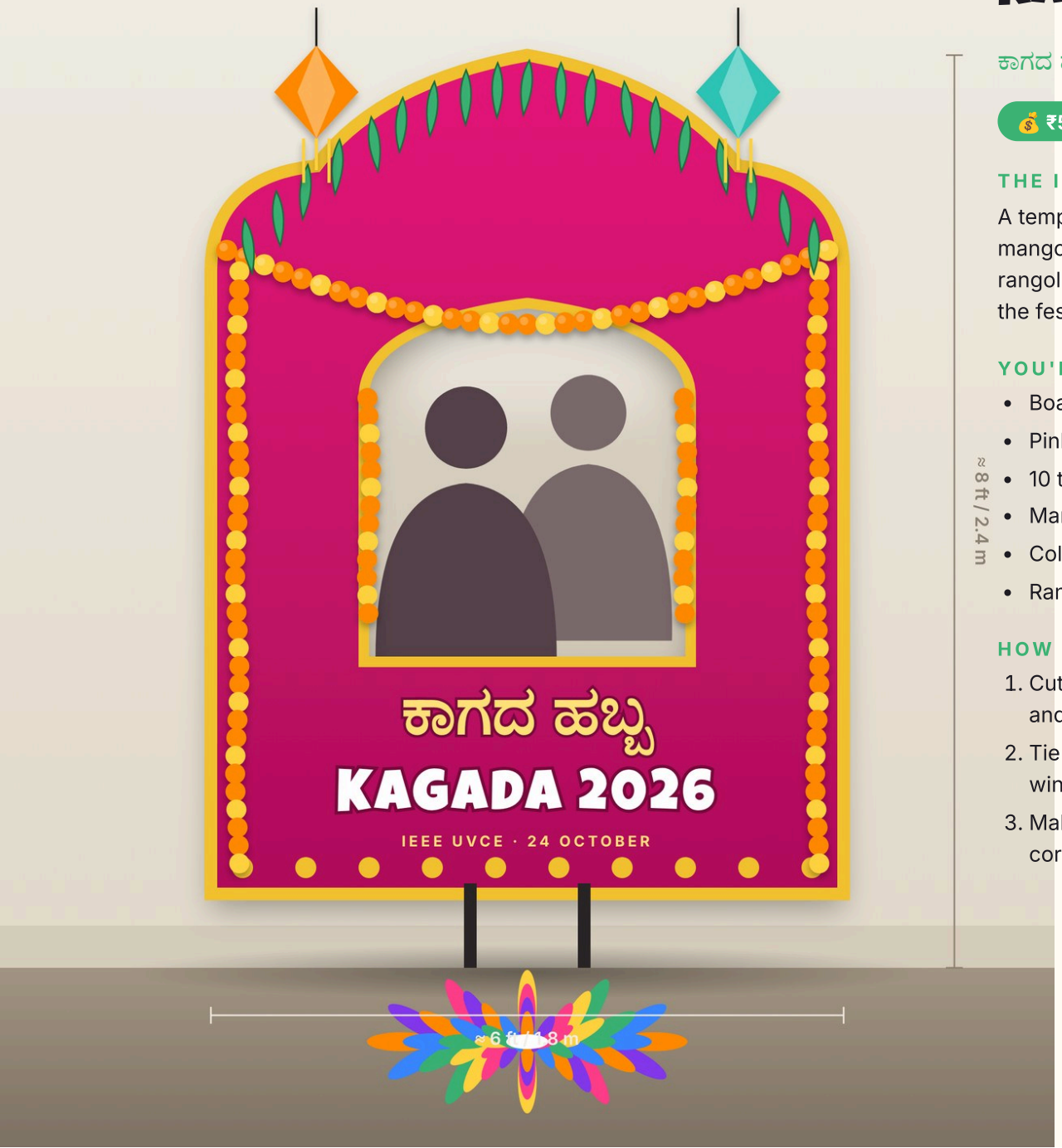
The booth is a page from a comic book: yellow and cyan halftone dots, thick black panel borders, a giant KA-GA-DA! explosion and a speech bubble. The window is the main panel and the participant is the superhero.

YOU'LL NEED

- Cardboard or the existing board
- Yellow, cyan, magenta and black poster paint (or coloured chart paper)
- Bottle caps or a pencil eraser to stamp the dots
- Black insulation tape for the thick panel borders
- White chart paper for the speech bubbles

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Paint the blocks in flat bright colours. Dip a bottle cap in a darker shade and stamp rows of dots for the halftone look.
2. Mark the panel borders with black insulation tape. It's fast and gives perfectly straight lines.
3. Cut the KA-GA-DA! starburst and speech bubbles from chart paper, outline them with a thick black marker, and glue them so they stick out past the board.



04
KAGADA HABBA GATE

ಕಾಗದ ಹಬ್ಬ: a festival gate, Mysuru Dasara style.

💰 ₹500–800 ⏱️ 1 day + 1 hour on the morning

THE IDEA

A temple-style arch in hot pink and gold, draped with marigold garlands and a mango-leaf toran, with two paper star lanterns (akash kandil) and a colourful rangoli on the floor in front. KAGADA comes right after Dasara, so it feels like the festival is still on.

YOU'LL NEED

- Board cut into an arch shape (or cardboard arch taped onto the board)
- Pink paint or pink chart paper, gold glitter paper for borders
- 10 to 15 marigold strings from KR Market (cheap the week after Dasara)
- Mango leaves on a string (toran)
- Coloured chart paper + sticks for 2 star lanterns
- Rangoli colours for the floor

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Cut the arched top from cardboard and tape it to the board. Paint it pink and trim it with gold paper.
2. Tie the toran across the top and hang marigold strings in loops around the window and down both sides.
3. Make 2 star lanterns from chart paper and hang them from the top corners. Draw the rangoli in front on the morning of the event.



05
Crepe Streamer Portal

Walk through the rainbow.

💰 ₹350–600 ⏱️ Half a day, 4 people

THE IDEA

A deep purple board sprinkled with paper confetti, with a rainbow curtain of crepe-paper streamers hanging over the top of the window. Participants push through the streamers like walking onto a stage. Balloon clusters at the corners finish it off.

YOU'LL NEED

- Board painted deep purple or navy (or black chart paper)
- 15 to 20 crepe-paper rolls in rainbow colours (₹10–15 each)
- A hole punch and coloured paper scraps for confetti
- 30 to 40 balloons
- Cardboard + glitter or coloured paper for the letters

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Paint the board a dark colour so the rainbow pops. Glue punched paper confetti all over.
2. Tape crepe streamers across the top edge of the window: 10–15 cm wide strips, each a different colour, hanging about halfway down.
3. Tie balloon clusters at the 2 top corners and 1 bottom corner. Add cardboard letters wrapped in coloured paper.



06
KAGADA TV · CHANNEL 22

You're live on the KAGADA channel.

💰 ₹250–450 ⏱️ 1 day, 4 people

THE IDEA

A giant retro TV built from cardboard boxes: orange body, teal control panel, paper-plate knobs, stick antennas and a rainbow test-pattern strip. A red LIVE light makes every photo look like a broadcast.

YOU'LL NEED

- 3 or 4 big cardboard boxes (from appliance shops, free)
- Orange and teal paint or chart paper
- 2 paper plates + bottle caps for knobs and buttons
- 2 broom sticks or bamboo for antennas, with foil balls on top
- Coloured chart paper strips for the test pattern

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Tape the boxes into one big flat front. Cut the rounded screen window with a box cutter.
2. Paint the body orange and the side panel teal. Stick on paper-plate knobs and bottle-cap buttons.
3. Tape antennas behind the top, add the rainbow strip under the screen and a red LIVE circle in the corner.



07
Paper Plate Mandala

A rangoli you can stand inside.

💰 ₹250–400 ⏱️ 1 day, 6 people

THE IDEA

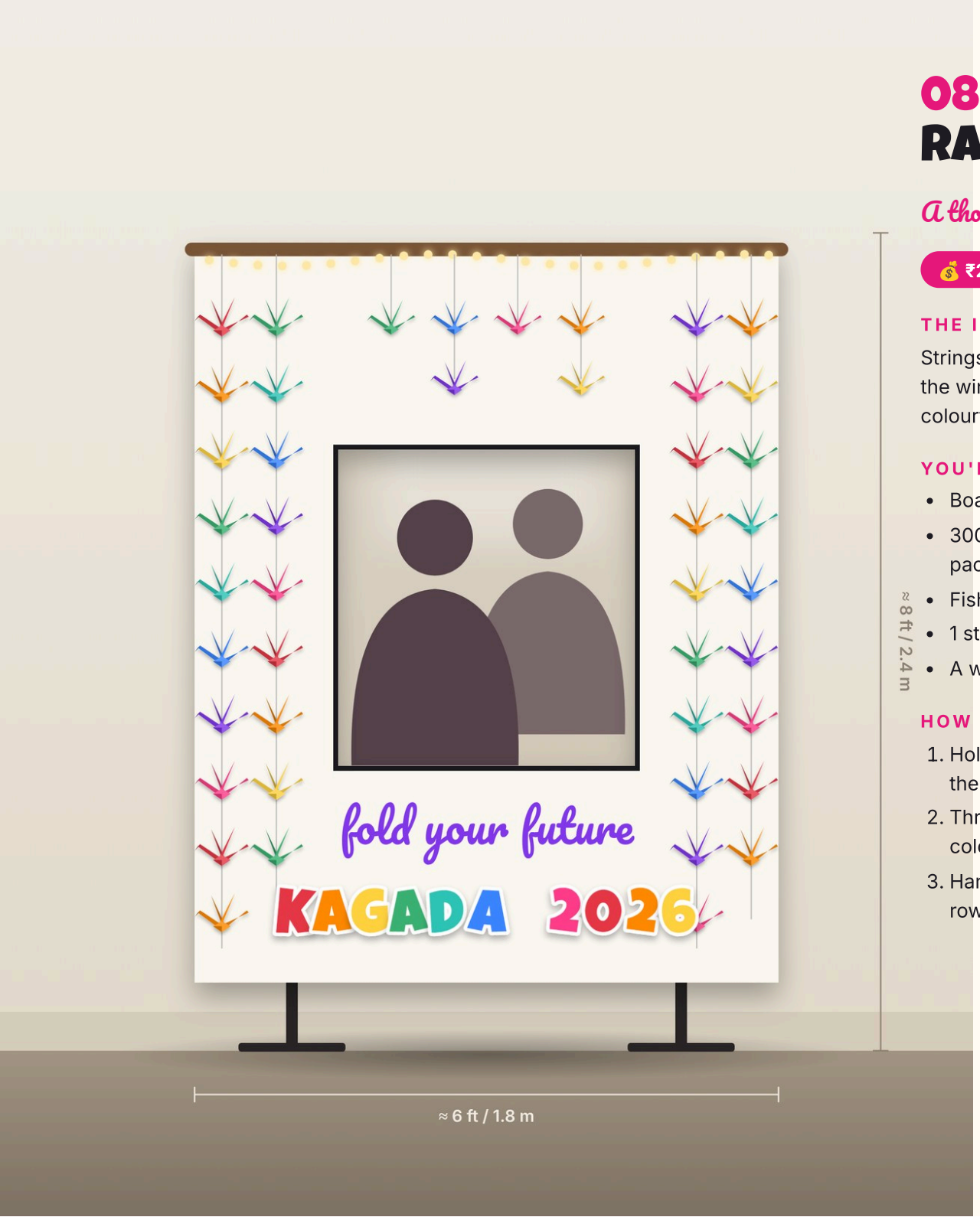
Painted paper plates arranged in rings around a round window, like a giant rangoli or mandala, on a deep indigo board. From far away it glows like a flower, and up close every plate is a mini artwork.

YOU'LL NEED

- Board painted deep indigo or black
- 50 to 60 paper plates in 2 sizes (₹1–2 each)
- Poster paints in 6 bright colours
- Glue gun
- A string and pencil to mark the circle

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Mark a circle on the board with a string-and-pencil compass and cut the round window with a jigsaw or box cutter.
2. Paint the plates in two-colour rings (outer rim one colour, centre another). This is a good job for 6 to 8 volunteers.
3. Glue the plates in rings around the window: small ones on the inside, big ones on the outside, and a few breaking past the board edges.



08
Rainbow Crane Cascade

A thousand folds, one photo.

💰 ₹200–400 ⏱️ 1 day, 10 people folding

THE IDEA

Strings of origami cranes in rainbow order fall like a curtain on both sides of the window, with a string of fairy lights along the top. It's simple, very colourful, and 100% paper, which is exactly what kagada means.

YOU'LL NEED

- Board painted white or covered with white chart paper
- 300 to 400 squares of coloured paper (cut from chart paper, or origami packs)
- Fishing line or thread, a needle
- 1 string of fairy lights (borrow one from Diwali stock)
- A wooden rod or PVC pipe across the top

HOW TO BUILD IT

1. Hold a crane-folding session: 10 volunteers × 1 hour ≈ 300 cranes. Fold them in rainbow colours.
2. Thread the cranes onto strings, about 5 cm apart, keeping each string in colour order.
3. Hang the strings from the top rod on both sides of the window, add a short row above it, and tape the fairy lights along the top.

Pick one & go

	BOOTH	COST	TIME
1	Paper Fan Burst	₹600–900	1 day, 6 people
2	Gaalipata Kite Sky	₹400–700	1 day, 4 people
3	Comic Book POW!	₹300–500	1 day, 4 people
4	Kagada Habba Gate	₹500–800	1 day + 1 hour on the morning
5	Crepe Streamer Portal	₹350–600	Half a day, 4 people
6	Kagada TV · Channel 22	₹250–450	1 day, 4 people
7	Paper Plate Mandala	₹250–400	1 day, 6 people
8	Rainbow Crane Cascade	₹200–400	1 day, 10 people folding

BEST FOR 3 DAYS AND NO BUDGET

1. **7 Paper Plate Mandala**: the cheapest showstopper. Plates cost ₹1–2 each and volunteers can paint them in parallel.
2. **6 Kagada TV**: the cardboard is free from any appliance shop, and everybody gets the joke.
3. **3 Comic Book POW!**: paint, bottle caps and black tape. Huge impact on Instagram.
4. **4 Kagada Habba Gate**: the most festive, and marigolds are cheap right after Dasara.

MIX & MATCH

- Crepe streamers (5) or fairy lights (8) can go on top of *any* booth for ₹100 extra.
- Make 5–6 prop sticks from leftover chart paper: speech bubbles, stars and a KA-GA-DA! starburst.

3-DAY PLAN

- **Day 1:** pick the booth, collect boxes, buy paper and paint, assign teams.
- **Day 2:** build. Run painting, folding and cutting in parallel.
- **Day 3:** assemble on the spot, then take test photos with a phone. Face the booth toward the light and hang a plain cloth behind the window.